

FREE GUIDE + TEMPLATE · STEP 4 OF YOUR ONBOARDING

Emailing a Contracting Officer

A poorly written email to a CO can quietly cost you credibility before you've submitted anything. Here's the etiquette that actually matters, plus two templates you can copy, fill in, and send today.

Etiquette rules

- Use a precise subject line: "[Solicitation Number] — Question from [Your Company Name]" — COs manage dozens of threads and search by solicitation number.
- Reference the exact section/page/clause number you're asking about. "I have a question about the PWS" forces them to guess; "Section C.3.2 of the PWS" doesn't.
- One thread per solicitation. Don't reply-all into an unrelated chain or start a new thread for each follow-up question on the same opportunity.
- Keep it to a few sentences. COs are not evaluating your writing here — they're evaluating whether you can get to the point.
- Don't call instead of emailing unless the solicitation specifically invites phone questions — an email creates a record; a call usually doesn't.
- Follow up once, after 3–5 business days, if you haven't heard back — not before, not repeatedly.
- Proofread your company name, UEI, and the solicitation number before sending. Typos here read as carelessness about details that matter.

Template — Asking a question before you bid

Subject: [Solicitation Number] — Question from [Your Company Name]

Dear [Contracting Officer Name],

My company, [Your Company Name] (UEI: [Your UEI]), is reviewing solicitation [Solicitation Number] and has a question regarding [Section/Page/Clause Reference].

[Your specific question, stated in one or two sentences.]

Please let me know if you need any additional information from us. Thank you for your time.

Best regards,

[Your Name]

[Your Title]

[Your Company Name]

[Phone] · [Email]

Template — Submitting your proposal by email

Subject: *Proposal Submission — [Solicitation Number] — [Your Company Name]*

Dear [Contracting Officer Name],

Please find attached our proposal in response to solicitation [Solicitation Number], submitted on behalf of [Your Company Name] (UEI: [Your UEI]).

Attached: *[list every file by name, e.g. "Technical Proposal.pdf, Price Proposal.xlsx, Capabilities Statement.pdf, Reps and Certs.pdf"]*

Please confirm receipt at your convenience. We're glad to provide any additional information.

*Best regards,
[Your Name]
[Your Title]
[Your Company Name]
[Phone] · [Email]*

Attachment checklist — confirm before you hit send

- File names match exactly what you listed in the email body
- Every required document from the Proposal Assembly Checklist is attached
- File formats match what the solicitation specifies (PDF vs. native Word/Excel)
- Total attachment size is under any stated email size limit — split or use a portal if not
- You're sending to the correct CO email address, copied from the solicitation itself

This guide is free, no strings attached. Last step: book your free strategy call to walk through your first real solicitation inside FASS Flow.
Questions: admin@fass.systems · flow.fass.systems